

National 1 League Referee Quick Guide

Oct 2, 2026 · @Deanna

U13-18/19U matches under the FIFA/U.S. Soccer Laws of the Game with the National 1 changes below ([Rules Handbook, Section 5](#)).

Age group	Game length	Half-time	Substitution moments
U13, U14	2 x 35 min	10 min	3 per half + halftime
U15, U16	2 x 40 min	10 min	4 per match + halftime
U17, 18/19U	2 x 45 min	10 min	4 per match + halftime

Key rules

Item	Rule
Game day roster	Max 18 players
Substitutions	Unlimited, at any stoppage, with your approval
Moments	Any sub during play counts as a moment, regardless of the opponent's sub
Sub policy	Coaches may not agree to change it
Minimum to start	7 players within 10 minutes of kickoff, or a forfeit
Check-in	Confirm passcards and roster before kickoff
Uniforms	Home light, away dark (opposite of UC Health Cup)
Sidelines	18 yards from goal lines, 2 yards from the touchline
Head injury	No trainer on site: no return to the match
Player sent off	Not replaced. Out for the rest of the day and next match
Coach dismissed	Out of sight and hearing. Out for the rest of the day and next match

Item	Rule
Yellow cards	No accumulation
Weather	Your call is final. Match is complete if the first half was finished

Game scoring / infraction records

- ☐ Confirm the score and complete the provided game card.
- ☐ Confirm team names, player names and numbers on the game card with the appropriate infraction.
- ☐ Turn the game card in at Referee HQ immediately after the game.
- ☐ Complete the After Game Report in Assignr.com as normal.
- ☐ Need a hand-written USSF Supplemental? Forms are available at Referee HQ.